



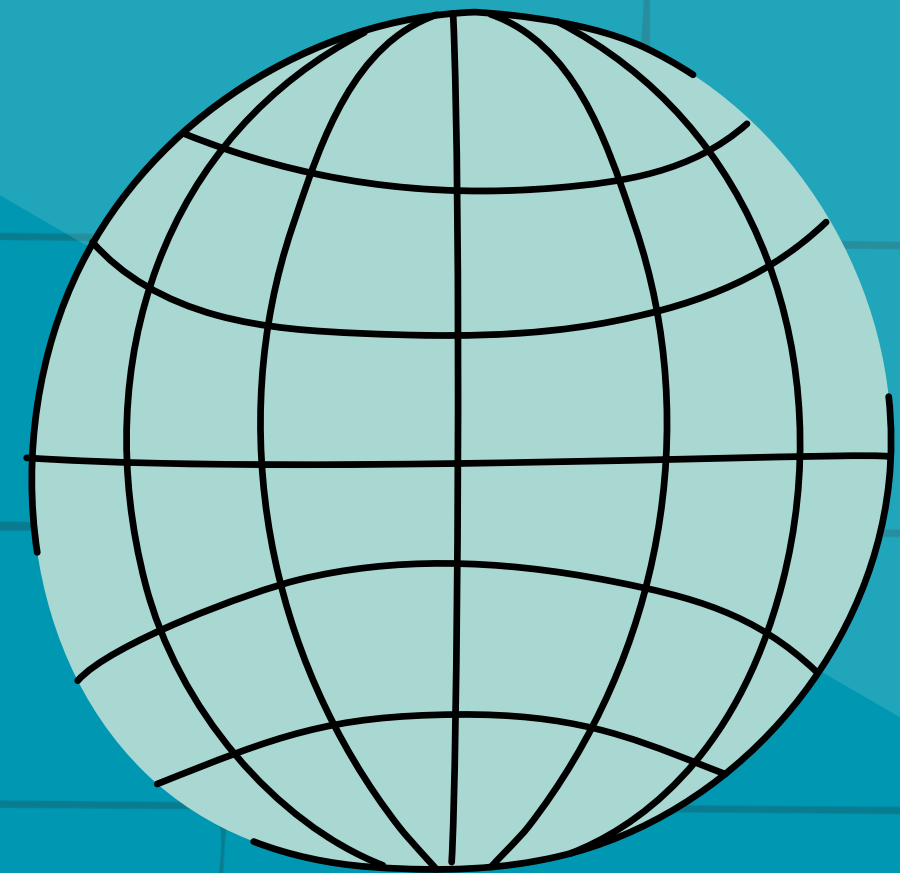
BEST PRACTICES FOR PAGER ROTATION

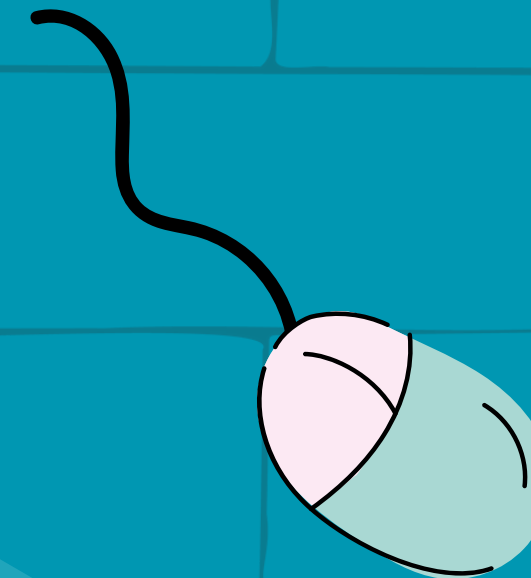
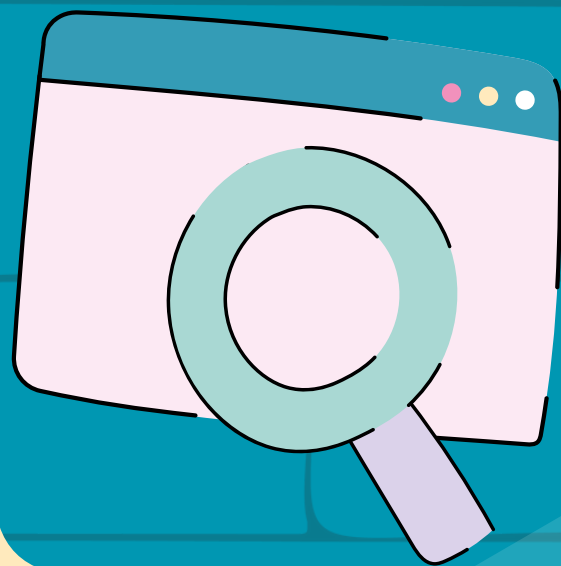
Alexis Mitchell
CSD 380
February 22, 2026

WHAT IS ON-CALL ROTATION?



- Structured schedule assigning availability outside normal hours
- On-call team respond to alerts, troubleshoot issues, and escalate when needed
- Often represents about 25% of an engineer's workload
- Common in SRE and operations teams





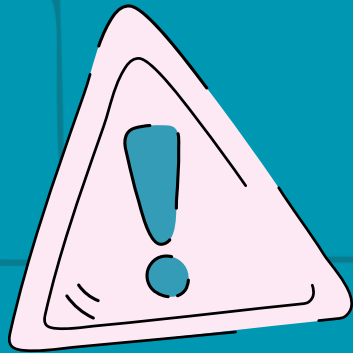
WHY IS PAGER ROTATION NEEDED?

Incidents
become more
complex as
organizations
grow - multiple
teams needed

Systems run
24/7 - needing
continuous
support

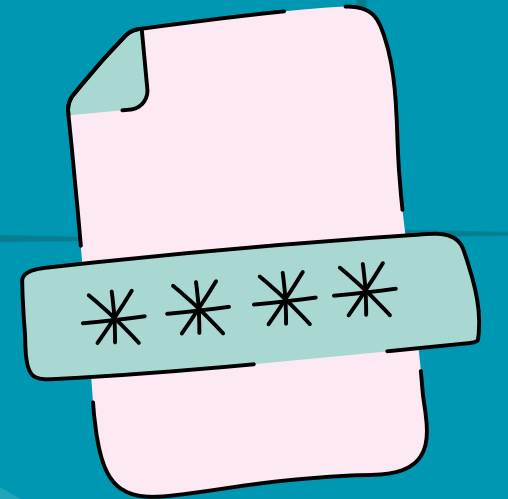
On-call
engineers act as
first line of
defense for
incidents

Essential for
maintaining
SLAs and
minimizing
downtime



Creates fair schedules
that distribute
workload evenly

Ensures coverage
while preventing
fatigue



BALANCED SCHEDULING

Prevents the same
people from always
being on call

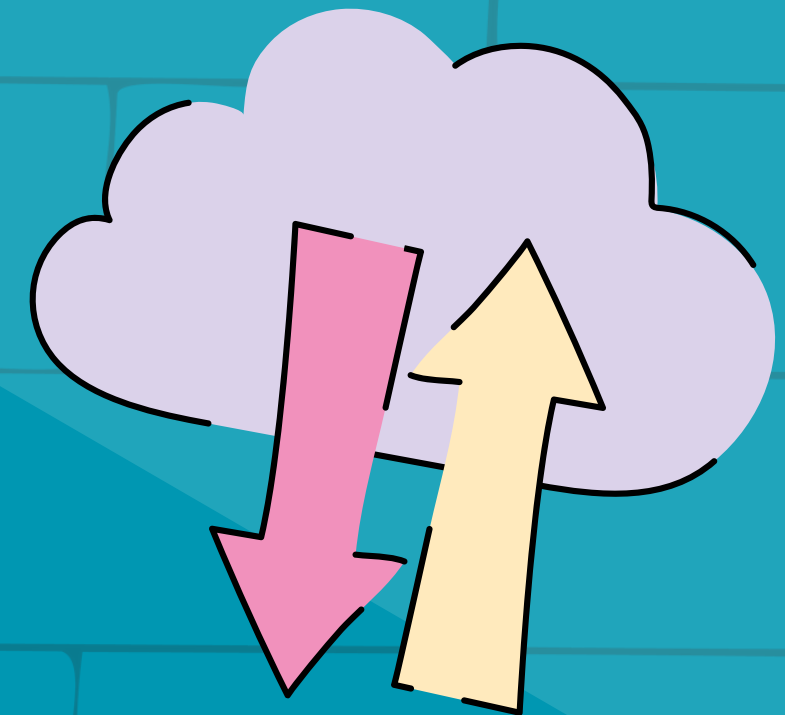
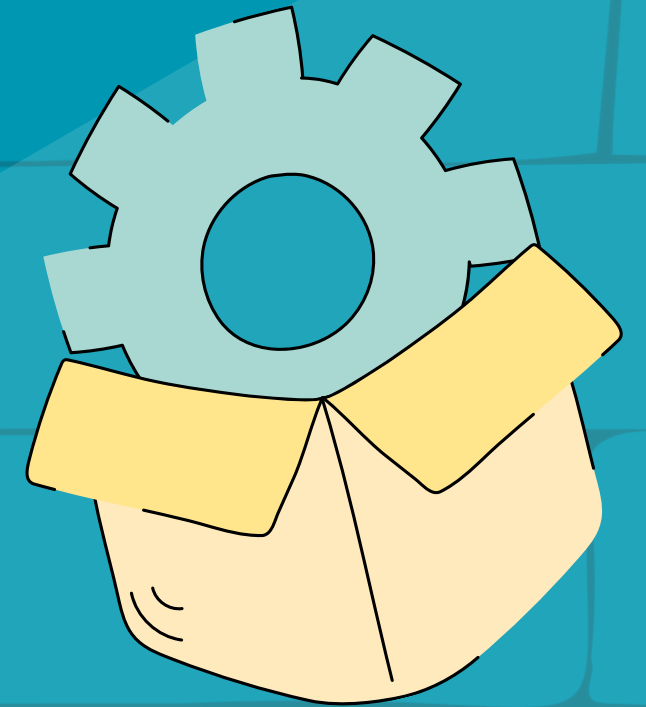
Track availability
of team
members

Plan for weekends,
holidays, and
overnight shifts



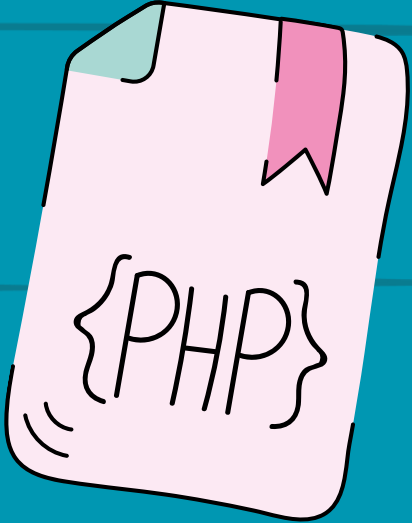
CLEAR ESCALATION POLICIES

- Define who is contacted first, second, etc.,
- Ensure the right expertise is contacted
- Critical for complex incidents involving multiple teams
- Automated routing increases response times
- Reduces confusion during emergencies





AUTOMATION OF ON-CALL TASKS



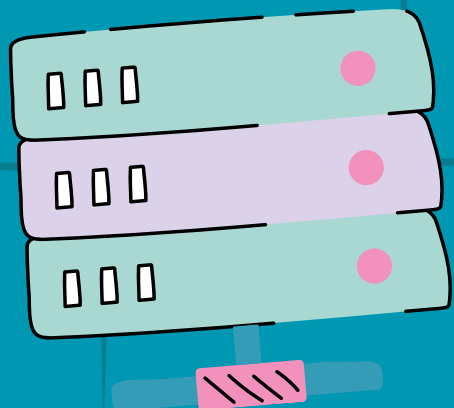
Use software to manage schedules and notifications

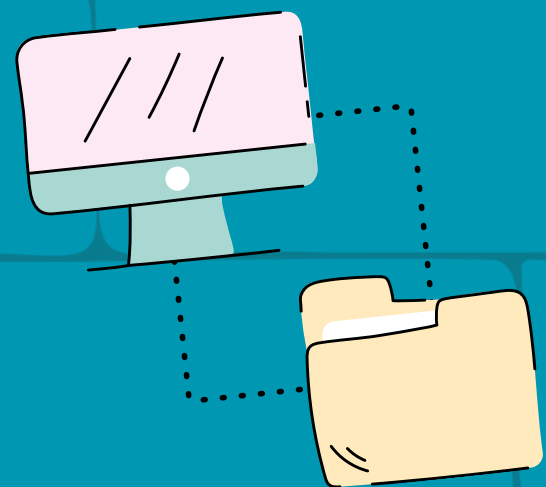
Auto alert engineers through multiple channels

Reduce human error

Allow shift swaps and schedule adjustments

More time to focus on solving problems





EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

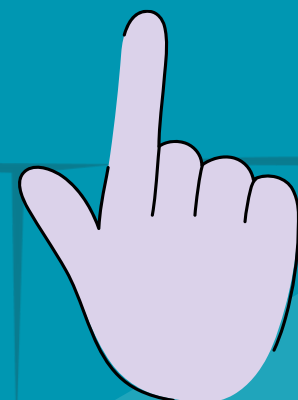


Incidents
often need
cross-team
coordination

Integration
with chat
platforms
helps
workflow

Teams can
share
updates, ask
for help, and
add experts
instantly

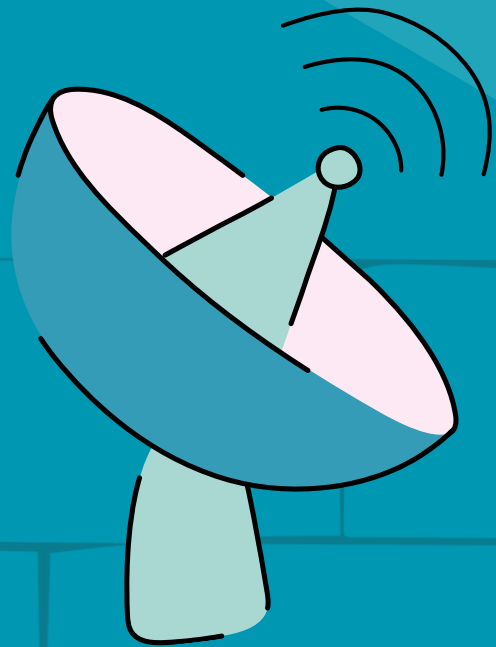
Centralized
communication
improves
coordination



ON-CALL SCHEDULING MODELS

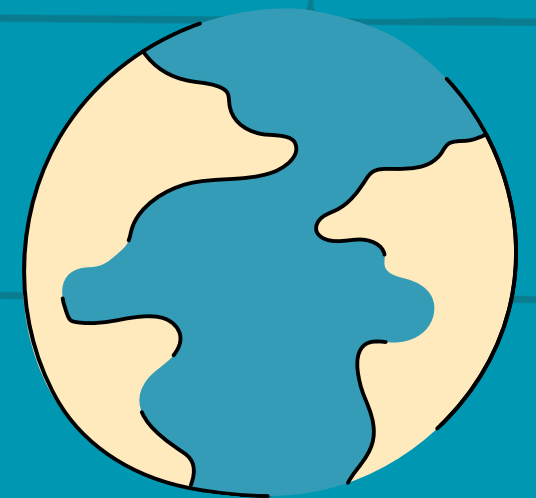
Follow-the-Sun

- Uses teams in different time zones
- Provides 24/7 coverage w/o overnight work



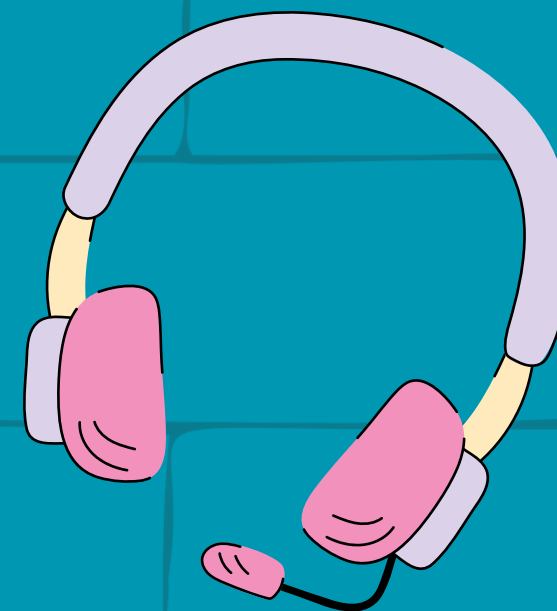
Single-Region Rotation

- Teams rotate shifts within one time zone
- May rotate quarterly or monthly
- Reduces repeated night duty





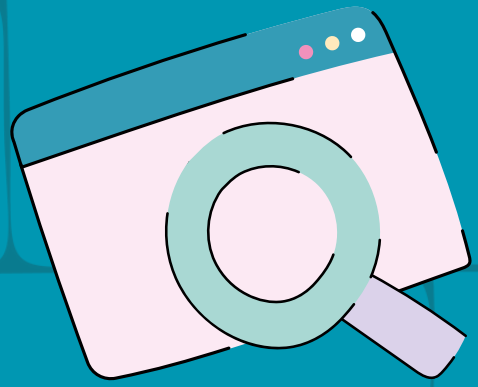
TOOLS SUPPORTING PAGER ROTATION



- Built-in scheduling and escalation management
- Integration with monitoring systems and logging tools
- Team can set custom notification preferences

 Jira Service Management

Alert  ops



CITATIONS



Cortex. (2021, February 13). Best practices for your team's on-call rotations.
<https://www.cortex.io/post/best-practices-for-on-call-rotations>

Squadcast. (2025, February 27). On-call rotation: A complete guide to best practices | by squadcast | medium. Medium. <https://medium.com/@squadcast/on-call-rotation-a-complete-guide-to-best-practices-997b0da54499>

Yogesh. (2025, July 3). Best practices for managing on-call rotation (in 2025). AlertOps. <https://alertops.com/on-call-rotation/>

